

# Saoud Rana

Dubai, UAE

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Visa Status: Resident Visa

[github.com/saoud](https://github.com/saoud)

Open to GCC Relocation

Nationality: American

## AI Product & Technical Project Manager | PropTech & SaaS Delivery

Technical leader and product manager specializing in the deployment of AI-driven automation and enterprise SaaS solutions. With over 8 years of experience scaling cloud infrastructure, DevSecOps, and platform operations, I bridge the gap between complex engineering execution and commercial real estate outcomes. Proven track record of owning the full product lifecycle—from discovery to launch—including the recent development of an n8n-backed "Lead-to-Lease" AI automation architecture tailored specifically for the UAE property sector.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

- **AI & PropTech Product Delivery:** LLM Orchestration, n8n Automation Workflows, Real Estate Lead-to-Lease Architectures, Prompt Engineering.
- **Project & Technical Management:** Full Lifecycle Discovery & Build, Agile Delivery, Cross-Functional Team Leadership, SLA/SLO Definition.
- **SaaS & Platform Operations:** AWS Infrastructure, API Integrations, CI/CD Pipelines, High-Availability Distributed Systems.

## Experience

### PropTech Automation Agency / Consultancy.

Dubai, UAE *Technical Architect & Product Lead*

2026 – Present

- Spearheaded the discovery, architecture, and development of a targeted PropTech automation agency project designed to streamline real estate operations.
- Engineered and deployed an end-to-end "Lead-to-Lease" AI automation system using n8n and Python microservices to instantly ingest, parse, and qualify incoming property inquiries.
- Replaced fragile, manual real estate workflows (e.g., spreadsheet tracking, WhatsApp document sharing) with structured databases and zero-touch API contracts, eliminating data loss and accelerating client response times.
- Designed the commercial and technical roadmap for integrating these AI agents into live property management and CRM environments, focusing on measurable ROI and rapid user adoption.

### BLOCKMAVEN, Remote

2024 – 2025

#### Engineering Lead & Cloud Architect

Led a globally distributed engineering team to **architect the company's core product: a decentralized, alternative internet backbone**. Held final authority on all technical decisions, from cloud infrastructure to designing a future-state, on-premise GPU hardware solution. **Represented the company in strategic meetings with industry partners** to define market needs and explore technical collaboration.

- **Secured critical, runway-extending funding by pioneering and pitching new strategic projects**, including a novel **on-device AI/ML authentication system** and new data-driven, blockchain-based reward platforms.
- Architected and deployed a secure, scalable cloud infrastructure on AWS from zero, implementing VPCs, IAM, and security groups to successfully launch and host the company's core AI models.
- Led the core AI/LLM engineering efforts, using prompt engineering and AI orchestration (via tools like n8n) to chain multiple LLMs and deliver complex business results.
- Established the company's first end-to-end CI/CD pipeline using Jenkins, Docker, and GitHub Actions, enabling automated, reliable code deployments for the entire engineering team.
- Migrated the primary codebase from GitHub to a self-hosted GitLab instance to enhance security, reduce costs, and gain full control over the company's intellectual property.

### CREDLY / PEARSON, Remote

2022 - 2024

#### Senior Platform Operations Engineer

Acted as a senior technical escalation point, resolving complex customer issues by analyzing API request/response logs and querying SQL databases. Contributed to weekly production code releases and actively improved support processes through scripting and documentation.

- Authored and maintained a library of Ruby scripts and complex pSQL queries to investigate backend issues, significantly reducing mean time to resolution (MTTR) for data-related escalations.
- Troubleshoot and debugged customer-facing API integrations by analyzing request/response logs, identifying root causes in code and data to accelerate bug fixes for the engineering team.
- Managed the technical escalation queue from Support to Engineering, prioritizing critical issues and ensuring 100% compliance with SLA response times.
- Authored and improved internal technical documentation and public-facing knowledgebase articles based on escalated issues, reducing ticket volume for common problems.

## LYELL, Seattle, WA

2021 - 2022

### Senior Infrastructure Engineer

Led an IT team of 3, directing all site operations and IT infrastructure for the multi-site Bothell and Seattle locations. Oversaw the complete IT ecosystem, including network administration (wired, wireless, VPN), vendor management, and the portfolio of all on-premise servers and SaaS applications.

- Led all IT infrastructure, network, and security camera deployment for a new biomedical manufacturing facility, ensuring 100% operational readiness and on-time launch for the new site.
- Architected and rolled out a complete "zero-touch" onboarding system, combining API-driven account automation with a new zero-touch hardware deployment process, dramatically reducing manual IT workload and new hire setup time.
- Developed and deployed a Slack help-bot that autonomously answered common user questions, measurably reducing routine helpdesk ticket volume and interruptions.
- Managed the company-wide rollout of CrowdStrike endpoint protection, resulting in a 100% reduction in virus-related support tickets and dramatically enhancing security posture.

## 98POINT6, Seattle, WA

2019 - 2020

### Site Reliability Engineer (SRE)

Provided 24/7 infrastructure engineering and on-call support for a HIPAA-compliant virtual clinic. Supported ~40 clinicians and ~200 corporate staff by designing, automating, and managing critical IT, network, and security systems.

- Reduced physician onboarding time by 60x by replacing a fully manual process with an automated, zero-touch deployment system (BetterCloud, OneLogin). This new workflow ensured correct group-based access to all SaaS applications from Day 1.
- Closed a critical security and HIPAA compliance gap by building automated offboarding workflows that instantly revoked all system access, ensuring no access was left for terminated users.
- Served in a 24/7 on-call rotation, responding to high-priority infrastructure outages and writing Correction of Errors (COE) analyses to implement long-term solutions and prevent recurrence.
- Managed critical Infrastructure as Code (IaC) by updating and maintaining Terraform scripts for DNS and server configuration management.
- Engineered and managed the Sumo Logic logging platform, ingesting system logs and creating custom alerts to proactively identify and resolve infrastructure incidents.
- Designed and deployed a hybrid-cloud network solution, configuring a backup data center VPN with redundant tunnels to AWS to ensure high-availability and business continuity.
- Enhanced network security by upgrading the RADIUS server to enforce multi-factor authentication (MFA) for all network access.
- Authored a comprehensive internal knowledge base for all common IT processes, empowering users to self-serve and significantly reducing low-level support tickets.

## GOOGLE, Seattle, WA

2018 - 2019

### Technical Solutions Engineer

Provided technical engineering support for pre-release (alpha/beta) pilot programs for new metering devices. Acted as the primary technical liaison for alpha testers, managing the hardware provisioning and end-to-end feedback lifecycle.

- Reduced support escalations by 60% by acting as the key liaison between engineering, product management, and business partners to prioritize and resolve bug fixes.
- **Managed and coordinated offsite Level 1 and Level 2 support teams**, ensuring efficient triage and resolution of all partner-reported issues.
- **Authored the core technical documentation and support playbooks to operationalize the pilot program**, enabling its successful transition to a production-scale process.

## SPEEDTEST.NET BY OOKLA, Seattle, WA

2015 - 2017

### Technical Services Representative

Provided high-level technical support and training for premium, enterprise-level clients via Zendesk on application use and networking structure.

- Developed and maintained scripts to enable and troubleshoot customized client installations.
- Authored public-facing technical documentation and knowledge base articles for the company website.
- Assisted the engineering team with Quality Assurance (QA) testing and bug reporting for new product releases.

### ADDITIONAL RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

- **CHIEF TECHNICAL OFFICER | COMPUTER INSANITY, JACKSONVILLE, FL**
- **HEAD OF IT | BAYMEADOWS HEALTHCARE, JACKSONVILLE, FL**
  - **AS THE SOLE TECHNICAL AUTHORITY, LED THE COMPLETE MIGRATION FROM PAPER RECORDS TO A NEW ELECTRONIC MEDICAL RECORD (EMR) SYSTEM AND TRAINED ALL STAFF.**
- **SENIOR IMPLEMENTATION SPECIALIST (TEAM LEAD) | STARBUCKS, SEATTLE, WA**
- **WEB ADMINISTRATOR & AUTHOR | AUTOMOTIVE ADDICTS, JACKSONVILLE, FL**

## Technical Skills

**Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS (Lambdas, VPC, IAM), Azure, Google Cloud (GCP), Oracle Cloud, Terraform, Docker

**DevOps & CI/CD:** Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Artifactory, Git

**AI & Automation:** AI Engineering, LLM Orchestration, Prompt Engineering, n8n, Zapier

**Scripting & Languages:** Python, Ruby on Rails, Bash, JavaScript, C++, SQL

**Security & Identity:** Crowdstrike, OneLogin, Okta, Duo, HIPAA Compliance, Zero Trust

**Monitoring & Operations:** Sumo Logic, Grafana, PagerDuty, Tableau, Jira, FreshService, Linux (RHEL/Ubuntu)

**Enterprise & Collaboration:** Google Workspace (Admin), Microsoft 365, Slack, Confluence, Zendesk, Salesforce

### Languages

- **English:** Native/Fluent
- **Urdu:** Native/Fluent
- **Punjabi:** Conversational
- **American Sign Language:** Fluent

### Education / Training

- **Full-Stack Web Development Certificate (2021)**
  - Institution: Epicodus, Seattle, WA
  - *Technologies: JavaScript, C#, .NET, MVC, React, Redux, MySQL, NoSQL*
- IT and Economics, Florida State College, Jacksonville, FL
- Medical Studies, King Edward Medical College, Lahore, Pakistan